
Implement AI Automations in the ChatGPT App

Step-by-step playbook for email, briefs, calendar, and spreadsheets

Snapshot for September 2026 • Plus / Go / Pro / Business / Enterprise

This guide turns the automation ideas from the previous list into working jobs inside ChatGPT. The native feature is **Scheduled tasks** (sidebar: *Scheduled*). It replaced Pulse. You describe the job and the time in plain language. ChatGPT confirms a card. The task then runs in the background and notifies you.

1 What you need before you start

- A paid ChatGPT plan. Scheduled tasks are on Go, Plus, Pro, Business, and Enterprise — not the free tier.
- The official ChatGPT app (iOS / Android) or chatgpt.com. Desktop apps can create tasks; the full Scheduled hub is most reliable on web and mobile.
- Notifications enabled for ChatGPT (phone + browser).
- Connected apps if the task must read mail, calendar, Drive, Slack, or Teams.

Plan caps (reported, confirm in your account): Go $\approx$ 3 active tasks; Plus $\approx$ 5; Business $\approx$ 10; Pro / Enterprise $\approx$ 15. Tasks run at most once per hour. Idle tasks can auto-pause. Custom GPTs and one-off file uploads are *not* available inside a scheduled run. Connected apps and web search *are*.

2 Part A — One-time setup (do this once)

2.1 A1. Turn on notifications

1. Open the ChatGPT mobile app → profile → Settings → Notifications. Enable push.
2. On web: browser settings → allow notifications for chatgpt.com.
3. Send yourself a test: in a chat type **Remind me in 2 minutes to test notifications**. Confirm the card. Wait for the ping.

2.2 A2. Connect the apps the jobs will use

1. Web: click your profile → **Settings** → **Connected apps** (sometimes labelled Apps).
2. Mobile: profile → Settings → Apps / Connected apps.
3. Connect only what you need:
 - Gmail or Outlook — inbox triage, invoices, follow-ups.
 - Google Calendar or Outlook Calendar — daily brief, meeting prep.
 - Google Drive / OneDrive — sheets and docs.
 - Slack or Microsoft Teams — company pulse (workspace admin may have to approve).
4. Complete OAuth. Grant the smallest scope that still works (read-only first).
5. If you are on a company workspace, ask IT before connecting a personal ChatGPT account to work mail.

2.3 A3. Find the Scheduled page

1. On web or mobile, open the left sidebar.
2. Tap **Scheduled** (on some accounts it still sits under the profile menu as Tasks).
3. You will see active jobs, next run time, pause / edit / delete.

2.4 A4. How every task is created

There is no separate “automation builder.” You type a normal message that includes **what** and **when**.

Template

Every [cadence] at [time + timezone], do [one job]. Use [connected app or the web]. Output as [format]. If nothing changed, reply with “No material update.” Do not send email or change files unless I said so.

After you send it, ChatGPT shows a confirmation card. Check name, time, and timezone. Tap confirm. Then open **Scheduled** and verify the next run.

Good cadence language: “Every weekday at 08:00 Western European Time”, “Every Monday at 09:00”, “Tomorrow at 15:00”, “Every morning”. **Weak language:** “sometime”, “when you can”, “daily” with no clock — it may still schedule, but the time will drift.

3 Part B — Implement the starter pack

Do these five first. Pause anything that is noisy after two runs.

3.1 B1. Morning news + calendar brief

Goal. One message at 07:30 with calendar, top news in your field, and three priorities.

1. Connect Google Calendar or Outlook Calendar (A2).
2. Start a new chat. Name it *Morning brief* in the chat title if the UI allows.
3. Paste:

Every weekday at 07:30 Western European Time, prepare my morning brief.

1. List today’s calendar events with time, attendees, and one prep note each. 2. Summarize the 8 most important stories from the last 24 hours in my industry: [NAME YOUR INDUSTRY / COMPETITORS]. 3. Flag anything that needs a decision today. 4. End with three suggested priorities.

Keep it under 400 words. Use web search and my connected calendar. If the calendar is empty, say so. Do not invent meetings.

4. Confirm the card. Open Scheduled → confirm next run is tomorrow 07:30.
5. After the first run: reply in that chat with corrections (“shorter”, “drop sports”, “always include cash position”). ChatGPT can update the stored instructions.

3.2 B2. Email triage and draft replies

Goal. A digest of what needs a reply. Drafts only — you send.

1. Connect Gmail or Outlook. Prefer read access first.
2. Decide a label or folder for “needs me” if you use one.
3. Paste:

Every weekday at 08:15 Western European Time, review new email in my connected inbox from the last 16 hours.

Classify each thread as: Action, Waiting, FYI, Newsletter, or Noise. For Action items, draft a short reply I can paste. Do not send mail. List sender, subject, and why it matters in one line. Ignore newsletters unless they contain a deadline or invoice. Cap the digest at 12 items. If the inbox is quiet, say "Inbox clear."

4. Confirm. After two mornings, tighten the prompt: add VIP domains (@client.com) and banned senders.
5. Safety: never grant send permission until drafts are consistently good for two weeks.

3.3 B3. Meeting notes to action list

ChatGPT scheduled tasks cannot attach a live recording by themselves. Use this two-step pattern.

1. After each call, drop the transcript (or Whisper / Meet / Zoom recap) into the same chat named *Meeting actions*.
2. Then create a weekly sweeper:

Every Friday at 16:00 Western European Time, look at this chat history from the past week. Compile a single action list: task, owner, due date, source meeting. Flag anything with no owner. Do not invent owners. Format as a markdown table I can paste into a sheet.

3. Optional: connect Drive and ask it to draft a Google Doc instead of a chat reply (Business / Work plans with Drive write access).

3.4 B4. Invoices from email into a spreadsheet

Native ChatGPT cannot reliably append a private Google Sheet on every plan. Use the pattern that works on your tier.

Path 1 — ChatGPT only (any paid plan)

Every weekday at 18:00 Western European Time, search my connected inbox for invoices, receipts, and payment confirmations from the last 24 hours. Extract: date, vendor, amount, currency, invoice number, due date. Return a CSV block I can paste into Google Sheets. If none found, reply "No new invoices." Do not pay anything. Do not forward mail.

Then once a day paste the CSV into Sheets.

Path 2 — ChatGPT Work + Drive (if your plan can write Docs/Sheets) Ask: *Append those rows to the Google Sheet named Expenses 2026, tab Inbox.* Test with one fake invoice first.

Path 3 — Zapier / Make fallback Trigger: Gmail search subject:(invoice OR receipt) has:attachment. Action: ChatGPT / OpenAI extract fields. Action: Google Sheets → Create spreadsheet row. Use this if ChatGPT cannot write the sheet after two tests.

3.5 B5. Friday KPI narrative from one spreadsheet

1. Put the live numbers in a Google Sheet the task can see, or paste a weekly export into a dedicated chat.
2. Connect Drive if available.
3. Paste:

Every Friday at 15:00 Western European Time, open my connected Google Sheet named [SHEET NAME], tab [TAB]. Read the latest week versus the prior week for: revenue, pipeline, cash, churn or the columns I listed in this chat. Write a 6-sentence narrative for leadership: what moved, why it might have moved, what is still unknown, and one recommended action. Do not invent numbers that are not in the sheet. Quote the cells you used.

4 Part C — The rest of the catalogue (copy-paste)

4.1 C1. Newsletter pack

Every Sunday at 18:00, summarize newsletters in my inbox from the past 7 days into 10 bullets. Skip anything I already starred. One link per story maximum.

4.2 C2. Follow-up hunter

Every weekday at 17:30, find threads in my connected inbox where I promised a reply or a document and have not sent one in 3+ days. List sender, promise, and a draft follow-up. Do not send.

4.3 C3. VIP only alerts (monitoring task)

Watch my connected inbox. Notify me only when mail arrives from [list domains or names]. Summarize in 3 lines. Ignore everything else. Check at most once per hour.

4.4 C4. Competitor watch

Every weekday at 09:00, search the web for new pricing, product posts, funding, or jobs from [competitor A, B, C]. Report only material changes since yesterday. If nothing changed, reply “No material update.”

4.5 C5. Meeting prep pack

Every weekday at 07:45, for each meeting on today’s connected calendar that has an external attendee, produce: last 3 related emails, 5 talking points, and one risk. Skip internal standups.

4.6 C6. Company pulse (Slack / Teams)

Requires the Slack or Teams connector and admin approval.

Every weekday at 08:30, summarize new messages in [#channel names] from the last 16 hours. Group by: decisions, asks for me, risks. Ignore memes and automated bots. Post the brief only in this chat.

4.7 C7. Review miner

Every Monday at 09:00, search the web for new reviews of [product] on G2, Trustpilot, and the App Store from the last 7 days. Cluster praise and complaints. List bugs in a table.

4.8 C8. Threshold alert

Every weekday at 12:00, read [Sheet / public dashboard URL]. If [metric] is above [X] or below [Y], explain the likely cause in 5 lines and notify me. If it is inside the band, do not notify.

5 Part D — Manage, debug, and stay safe

5.1 D1. Edit, pause, delete

Open **Scheduled** → select the task → Edit. You can change name, instructions, frequency, and time. Or say in the original chat: *Change the morning brief to 07:00 and drop crypto news.*

5.2 D2. If a run is late or empty

- Check timezone on the card (WET vs UTC is a common miss).
- Confirm the app connection is still authorized.
- Narrow the prompt. “My industry” is weaker than “EU payments and three named competitors.”
- Remember the once-per-hour cap and the active-task cap.
- If the task paused after inactivity, open Scheduled and Resume, then run a manual test.

5.3 D3. Safety rules

- Draft, never send, until you have reviewed two weeks of output.
- Do not connect a personal ChatGPT account to regulated health, HR, or unpublished financials without a Business / Enterprise agreement.
- Assume OpenAI can see prompts and retrieved snippets under their data policy for your plan. Use Work / Enterprise if you need the stronger contract.
- Delete tasks you no longer use. An idle task with mailbox access is extra surface area.
- Human approval for money, legal, firing, and customer-facing sends.

6 Part E — When ChatGPT is not enough

Use Zapier, Make, or n8n when you need: more than your task cap, guaranteed sheet writes, Slack posts as a bot, or runs more often than hourly.

Typical Zapier shape:

1. Trigger: Gmail / Calendar / Schedule.
2. Action: ChatGPT or OpenAI Responses — your extraction prompt.
3. Action: Sheets row, Slack message, or Gmail draft (not send).

Keep the same rule: AI drafts, you approve anything irreversible.

7 30-minute implementation checklist

1. Paid plan + notifications on.
2. Connect calendar. Create B1 (morning brief). Confirm the card.
3. Connect mail (read-only). Create B2 (triage). Confirm.
4. Create B4 (invoice CSV) or B5 (Friday KPI).
5. Open Scheduled. You should see 2–3 tasks, next run times, and a pause control.
6. Tomorrow morning, edit the prompts based on the first real output. Do not add more tasks until these three are quiet and useful.

OpenAI changes labels and plan caps. If your sidebar does not show Scheduled, look under profile → Tasks, update the app, and check that you are on a paid plan. Always verify connected-app permissions before the first unattended run.